

Teste Modelo

Cyber-attack should be a wake-up call, says Microsoft

15th of May 2017

- ¹ The cyber-attack that has affected 150 countries around the world since Friday should be "a wake-up call" for governments, Microsoft says.
- ² It blamed governments for storing data on software that was open to attack, which was then accessed by hackers. Microsoft said the latest virus took advantage of a weakness in Microsoft Windows that was noticed by US investigators. Information about this was stolen from the NSA (National Security Agency).
- ³ Many companies and organisations worldwide became victims of the WannaCry attack, including Britain's NHS (National Health Service), US courier service FedEx and French car maker Renault.
- ⁴ Russia was one of the countries that was badly affected, its Central Bank and government office computers were attacked by the virus.
- ⁵ In China, state media said more than 29,000 organisations across the country were affected, most of which were academic.
- ⁶ The virus takes control of users' files and demands \$300 to get back access to data. To prevent new infections, many companies had experts working on the problem over the weekend.
- ⁷ More than 200,000 computers were affected since the attack began. By Monday, the virus was not spreading as fast, but people were still reporting cases.
- ⁸ On Monday morning, researchers found that only about \$38,000 had been paid into the accounts linked to the attacks.
- ⁹ The virus threatens to delete files within seven days if the ransom is not paid, and also warns that the ransom amount will double after three days.
- ¹⁰ In a statement on Sunday, Microsoft president and chief legal officer Brad Smith criticised the way governments store information about security weaknesses in computer systems.
- ¹¹ The company also said that many organisations had failed to keep their systems up-to-date, which allowed the virus to spread. Microsoft said they had released a Windows security update in March, but many users hadn't run it. He added that if customers didn't update their systems, there was no way for them to protect themselves against attacks.
- ¹² Updating a personal computer can be very simple, but for an organisation like Britain's NHS, which was badly affected, it is expensive, complex and takes a lot of time.
- ¹³ The attack has also spread faster and more easily than previous ones. Once the virus infects one computer within a network, it can spread to all the computers in that network "within seconds," said Israel Levy, the CEO of the internet security firm Bufferzone.
- ¹⁴ For example, if one of your colleagues opens an infected PDF that is attached to an email, soon everyone in that office could be under attack.
- ¹⁵ Levy also said that six months ago, this problem didn't happen as this type of virus could only attack one machine at a time.
- ¹⁶ With help from a young security technician, the attack was stopped for a short time, but a new version of the virus soon started to infect computers again.
- ¹⁷ 22-year-old Marcus Hutchins, or 'MalwareTech', was called an "accidental hero" after he helped to slow down the progress of the virus. He bought a web address to track it, which stopped it by chance. The web security expert's boss gave him an extra week off work because of the unexpected events.

Sources: BBC News, CNN, The Telegraph

Checking understanding

Put true (T) or false (F) next to each statement. Say why the false statements are false.

1. A fault in a Microsoft programme was the reason that hackers could attack computers with a virus.
2. Microsoft said that it was their fault that hackers could access files on government systems.
3. China has reported only a few cases of the virus.
4. Many Windows users had run security updates.
5. The virus could only attack one computer at a time.
6. A young tech expert managed to stop the progress of the virus for a short time when he was trying to find out where it came from.

USE OF ENGLISH

A. Rephrase the sentences using the words in bold.

1. The fake website was populated with articles stolen from BBC News. The website was a scam. **Although**

2. He's an excellent programmer. However, he has never been promoted. **Despite**

3. Despite having a terrible headache, he went to the office. **However**

B. Rewrite the sentences using the words given.

1. Reboot your PC to see if the problem recurs. (should)

2. Avoid phoning in peak times. (never)

3. Use your PC's on-board diagnostic and repair tools. (strongly recommend)

4. Have your system up and running and be near it when you call. (best thing)

5. Record the details of the problem so you can describe it accurately. (good idea)

6. Note your system's model name and serial number. (advise)

C. Rewrite the following sentences ^{using} the passive voice.

1. The attacker is launching a pop-up ^{landscape} suggesting that recipients install an Android app for added-security.
2. The recipient has filled in a form with his mobile number and details and has sent it to the attacker.
3. The attacker sends a SMS to the recipient's mobile with a download link for iBanking.
4. Disguised as a legitimate app, iBanking will leak sensitive data to the attacker.

→ A pop-up (...) is being launched by the attacker.
→ A form with (...) has been filled in and sent to the attacker by the recipient
→ A SMS was sent to the recipient's mobile phone by the attacker (with a download link for iBanking.)
→ Sensitive data will be leaked to the attacker by iBanking, disguised as a legitimate app.

WRITING

- A. In terms of data safety some of the threats that we have to deal with on a daily basis are virus, worms, bots and trojans. Select two of these threats, present some of their characteristics and effective ways to protect our computers against them.

- B. Write a paragraph about one of your favourite apps. Describe some of its features and explain why you believe it is useful.